

The International Job Market for Economists

G. Stefán Guðmundsson



SCHOOL OF BUSINESS AND SOCIAL SCIENCES
AARHUS UNIVERSITY



ACE
Aarhus Center for Econometrics

The Job Market

Overview of Markets

The European Market

- Dates and location: Dec 14-17, 2026, virtual.
- Important websites:
 - European Economic Association:
<https://www.eeassoc.org>.
 - Job listings:
<https://www.eeassoc.org/jeeh-position-listings>.
 - European Job Market of Economists:
<http://www.europeanjobmarketofeconomists.org>.
- X/Twitter: @EEANews
- More job postings:
<https://www.econjobmarket.org>.

The U.S Market (ASSA Annual Meeting)

- Dates and location: Jan 3-5, 2027, Washington, DC.
 - Typically there is also a virtual option.
- Important websites:
 - American Economic Association:
<http://www.aeaweb.org/conference/>.
 - Job listings:
<http://www.aeaweb.org/joe/listings>.
- X/Twitter: @JOE_listings
- More job postings:
<https://www.econjobmarket.org>.

Financial Management Association (FMA)

- Dates and location: Oct 14-17, 2026, Tampa, Florida.
- Important websites:
 - Financial Management Association:
<http://www.fma.org/for-job-seekers>.

About the Market

Types of Positions

- Tenure-track assistant professor.
- Limited time junior faculty:
 - Post-doc.
 - Assistant professor.
- Other positions:
 - Lecturer/teaching positions.
 - Visiting assistant professor.
- Public sector postings: research economists, policy analysts, etc.
- Private sector postings: research associates, analysts, etc.

Market participants

■ Demand:

- Universities.
- Government agencies.
 - Central banks: Fed, ECB, BoE, etc.
 - Supervisory bodies: SEC, FDIC, etc.
- International organisations: IMF, World Bank, BIS.
- Companies.

■ Supply:

- Recent Ph.D. graduates.
- Students within a year of completion of Ph.D.
- Senior assistant professors and post-docs.

Process (Universities)

- 1 Application (September–November of year $t - 1$).
- 2 Screening interview online (or at European / ASSA meeting).
 - 20 minutes long.
 - Between 10–30 candidates for each position.
- 3 Fly-out to university:
 - One full day: Seminar talk, meeting with different faculty members, department head, maybe dean, dinner.
 - About 3–4 candidates per position.
- 4 Offer and negotiation.
- 5 Start job (typically August–September of year t).

Application

Application

■ Contents:

- Job market paper.
- CV.
- Cover letter
- Extras:
 - Teaching portfolio.
 - Teaching evaluations.
 - Research and teaching statements.

■ Sent separately:

- Reference letters (usually 3, one of which is from the supervisor).

- The material can be uploaded and updated on a **Job Openings for Economists (JOE)** profile (U.S.) or an **Econ Job Market (EJM)** profile (Euro), so subsequent applications are easier.

Other things to prepare

- Web site.
- Spreadsheet with applications, deadlines, names of contacts, etc.
- Presentation of job market paper (“job market talk”):
 - A 45-minute version (Europe).
 - An 80-minute version.
 - 1-minute, 3-minute, and 5-minute oral summaries (spiel).
- Present your job market paper at our department, conferences, other universities if you can.
- Other things:
 - Professional-looking clothing for the interviews/flyout helps.
 - Make sure your phone, laptop, cloud storage, backup, credit cards, passports, visa-status is all working and sorted.

Thoughts on where to Apply

- Trickle-down, expect to go down in ranking.
- Initial job has lasting effects on career and productivity.
- Post-doc versus assistant professor.
- Realistic prospects of tenure.
- Average number of applications per candidate about 100 (U.S.).
- Would you actually want to live there?

Guide and Calendar

Guide and Calendar

- Cawley wrote a nice guide for the job market:
 - See [here](#).
 - But keep in mind that it has not been updated since before covid.
- A rough calendar for the process can be found on my [website](#).